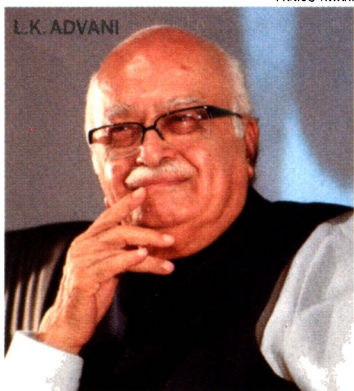




PANKAJ TIWARI

THOUGH IN THE OPPOSITION,
THE BJP COLLECTED
CRORE IN 2006-07 AS AGAINST
THE CONGRESS WHICH
RECEIVED CRORE



SONIA
GANDHI

SIPRA DAS

March 31, 2008, six months after the deadline of October 31, 2007.

Unlike the BJP, Mayawati's BSP seems to have no need for loans. The party took a donation in excess of Rs 20,000 in 2004-05, which it disclosed in its return: it received Rs 19 lakh from ITC Limited. In other years, Mayawati has enclosed an affidavit which says the party "has not received any single voluntary contribution in excess of Rs 20,000 during the year". The BSP collected Rs 45.05 crore during 2006-07 as against Rs 2.55 crore a year earlier. According to its tax re-

turn, the party purchased five properties in Lucknow for Rs 1.46 crore between January and May 2005. Strangely, it sold them a few months later for Rs 1.36 crore, a time when land prices were skyrocketing. The Samajwadi Party is no newbie to this great game. It collected Rs 80.47 crore during 2006-07, but disclosed sources for only Rs 6.57 lakh of this amount.

The CPI parks its money in private sector banks. It has deposits of Rs 1.15 crore with HDFC Bank as on March 31, 2007. The party has shown income from donations and party funds of Rs 44.18 lakh during 2006-07, of which sources for only Rs 12.69 lakh have been disclosed; most donations coming from party office-bearers. Big brother CPI(M) has a bigger pot. It acknowledges collecting Rs 24.90 crore during 2006-07; a list of 10 donors has been disclosed for a total of Rs 11.24 lakh.

Lalu Prasad Yadav's RJD had not filed its income tax return for 2007-08 till the first week of July this year, though the deadline was October 31, 2007. Having recently received the national party status from the Election

Commission, the RJD collects money under three heads: donations, *chunav kosh* (election fund) and *anudaan*. The party has collected Rs 5.29 crore under these three heads in the last three financial years, with Rs 75 lakh mobilised as donations and Rs 1.41 crore as *chunav kosh* during 2005-06.

Such funding routes apart, sale of coupons remains a traditional favourite with parties like the Congress and NCP. The NCP, which had not filed its ITR for 2007-08 till first week of July (i.e. the date of reply), collected Rs 6.05 crore during 2005-06 from sale of coupons, besides Rs 50.76 lakh through donations. It collected Rs 24.70 crore under these two heads without disclosing the sources over the last three years. On the other hand, despite being in and out of power in India's richest state, Punjab, Shiromani Akali Dal has shown a meagre income of Rs 5.19 lakh for 2005-06. Similarly, Ram Vilas Paswan's Lok Janshakti Party showed an income of Rs 78.49 lakh during 2006-07 from donations and sale of coupons.

Records show that over the last three financial years, the seven recognised national parties together collected over Rs 814 crore from donations and voluntary contributions. Of this, the 1,134 donors that the parties have named in their returns account for only Rs 87 crore. You can follow the money, but you won't see it coming. At least not the overwhelmingly larger chunk.

THE CPI HEAD-
QUARTERS, AJYO
BHAVAN, ON
ROUSE AVENUE IN
NEW DELHI



YASBANT NEGI

THE CPI PUTS A VALUE
OF Rs 11.24 LAKH ON
ITS HQ. ITS ACTUAL
WORTH IS SEVERAL
TIMES MORE.